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| PANEL 1/14 - BOUNDARY, CHRONOLOGY AND CENTRAL THESIS |
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| -> Core frame: c. sixth-fourth centuries BCE within a longer, uneven c. 600-200 BCE early- |
|      historic transition. |
| -> Middle Ganga evidence is densest; this is not an all-India census or a sudden 600 BCE |
|      revolution. |
| -> Topic 11 owns mahajanapadas/Magadha narrative; Topic 14 owns Mauryan imperial |
|      administration. |
| -> Thesis: territorial power, surplus and social ranking changed together, but through |
|      regional and contested processes. |
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| PANEL 2/14 - SOURCE VOICES, GENRES AND SILENCES |
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| -> Buddhist Nikaya/Vinaya: social categories and monastic norms; layered oral transmission |
| and redaction. |
| -> Jataka/later Buddhist and Jain traditions: rich social memory; chronology and sectarian |
| purpose require control. |
| -> Dharmasutra/Grihyasutra: Brahmanical prescriptions for varna, household and penalty; norm |
| is not practice. |
| -> Archaeology/coins: settlement, NBPW, forts, craft and circulation; they rarely identify |
| varna or institutions alone. |
| -> Method: claim -> named source/material -> inference -> genre, date, region and silence |
| limit. |
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| PANEL 3/14 - SECOND URBANISATION AS AN URBAN-RURAL SYSTEM |
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| -> Villages and cultivation -> food, raw materials and labour -> towns and political |
| centres. |
| -> Towns/routes -> specialised crafts, markets, credit and political demand -> rural |
| opportunities and extraction. |
| -> NBPW is one fine-ware horizon; coins one exchange indicator; fortification one |
| mobilisation indicator. |
| -> City test = scale/hierarchy + crafts + exchange + public/defensive works + routes + |
| hinterland. |
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| PANEL 4/14 - STATE-SURPLUS-STRATIFICATION CAUSAL CHAIN |
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| -> Ecology + rice/crops + tools + water + labour + settlement growth -> expanded production |
| possibilities. |
| -> Household surplus -> tax/tribute/toll/fine + market/credit + rent/service + gift |
| channels. |
| -> Resources -> courts, officials, forts, armies, urban specialists and monastic |
| institutions. |
| -> Unequal appropriation -> gahapati/setthi influence, dependent labour and sharper status |
| differences. |
| -> Qualification: iron enabled; institutions, labour and power converted. No single-cause |
| determinism. |
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| PANEL 5/14 - TERRITORY, CAPITALS, FORTS AND LAYERED SOVEREIGNTY |
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| -> Jana/kin authority -> janapada territoriality -> larger competing states with claims over |
| settlements, routes and people. |
| -> Capitals concentrated court, defence, storage, exchange and communication; founding dates |
| remain source-specific. |
| -> Fortifications indicate labour mobilisation and insecurity, not absolute rule over every |
| surrounding household. |
| -> Local clan elites, village heads, corporate bodies and household power survived inside |
| expanding states. |
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| PANEL 6/14 - MONARCHY AND GANA-SANGHA |
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| -> Monarchy: dynastic king/court -> concentrated command, succession politics, ministers, |
|     army and patronage. |
| -> Gana-sangha: restricted ruling-clan corporate body -> chief, council/assembly and shared |
|     elite authority. |
| -> Santhagara and salaka suggest procedure; they do not preserve one universal constitution. |
| -> Both extracted resources, punished, negotiated and fought; neither offered universal |
|     citizenship. |
| -> Exam trap: ancient republic = oligarchic and restricted, not modern democracy. |
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| PANEL 7/14 - OFFICIALS, TAXATION, ARMY, LAW, JUSTICE AND ORDER |
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| -> Texts mention ministers/amattas, mahamattas, commanders, judges/accountants and village |
|      leaders. |
| -> Shared title does not prove identical function; never import the full |
|      Arthashastra/Ashokan hierarchy backward. |
| -> Bhaga/produce shares, bali, tolls and fines varied; named fractions are prescriptions, |
|      not audited uniform rates. |
| -> Organised forces and forts show coercive capacity; exact pre-Mauryan standing-army totals |
|      are insecure. |
| -> Status-sensitive legal norms are visible; actual adjudication by rulers/agents remains |
|      poorly documented. |
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| PANEL 8/14 - AGRARIAN EXPANSION, TOWNS, COINS AND CORPORATE ECONOMY |
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| -> Land held overlapping cultivator, household, village, chief/king and revenue claims; no |
| one uniform ownership regime. |
| -> Punch-marked coins + Pali terms kahapana, nikkha, kamsa, pada, masaka, kakanika -> uneven |
| monetisation. |
| -> Barter and payments in kind continued; coin circulation does not identify one issuer or |
| universal money use. |
| -> Vanija, artisans and shreni/puga/nigama indicate trade and guild-like association with |
| source-layer limits. |
| -> Urban-rural exchange linked food, craft goods, forest products, credit, transport and |
| state demand. |
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| PANEL 9/14 - VARNA IDEOLOGY, JATI AND STATUS PRACTICE |
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| -> Varna = broad Brahmanical prescriptive hierarchy; jati = context-sensitive |
|     birth/kind/lineage/social group. |
| -> Occupation, kinship, wealth, political office and region intersected but did not equal |
|     varna or each other. |
| -> Brahmana-Kshatriya relation combined rank contest with ritual-political cooperation and |
|     patronage. |
| -> Vaishya does not equal every merchant; vessa, gahapati and setthi map imperfectly onto |
|     prescription. |
| -> Shudra subordination is clear in norms, but every worker, artisan, slave or forest person |
|     was not automatically Shudra. |
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| PANEL 10/14 - HOUSEHOLD ELITES, LABOUR, DEPENDENCY AND EXCLUSION |
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| -> Gahapati/grihapati: substantial household/property-holder, often agrarian; not every |
|     ordinary householder. |
| -> Setthi/shreshthin: urban business, credit or corporate elite; overlaps with but is not |
|     synonymous with gahapati. |
| -> Kassaka cultivators varied; kammakara/bhataka mark hired/service labour; dasa/dasi mark |
|     dependent or unfree status contextually. |
| -> Debt, capture, birth and service created different dependencies; no reliable population |
|     proportions survive. |
| -> Chandala, Nisada and pukkusa show stigma/exclusion in specific sources, not a finished |
|     timeless caste schedule. |
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| PANEL 11/14 - HOUSEHOLD, PROPERTY, PATRIARCHY AND WOMEN |
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| -> Patrilineal continuity, controlled marriage and male inheritance privilege structure many |
|      normative texts. |
| -> Women nevertheless worked, managed resources, gave gifts and appeared as householders, |
|      patrons and urban actors. |
| -> Ambapali = wealthy ganika/donor; Visakha = lay patron; exceptional visibility is not |
|      general equality. |
| -> Buddhist bhikkhuni and Jain female orders opened renunciant paths but retained admission, |
|      discipline and status constraints. |
| -> Male-authored elite sources under-record ordinary female labour: silence must be stated, |
|      not filled by guesswork. |
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| PANEL 12/14 - SHRAMANA CRITIQUE AND THE PERSISTENCE OF HIERARCHY |
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| -> Buddhist, Jain and other renunciants criticised sacrifice, attachment and the moral |
| sufficiency of birth. |
| -> Renunciation could cross some household/varna boundaries and create new male and female |
| institutional identities. |
| -> Sanghas relied on alms, gardens, protection and gifts from kings, gahapatis, setthis, |
| women and corporate groups. |
| -> Rules for debtors, slaves, soldiers and nuns reveal institutional limits; lay patriarchy |
| and stigma persisted. |
| -> Verdict: important ethical critique and institutional alternative, not a simple merchant |
| or anti-caste revolution. |
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| PANEL 13/14 - PERIPHERIES, MOBILITY, DONORS AND CONTROLLED COMPARISON |
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| -> Forest, hunting, pastoral and tribal groups exchanged products, supplied labour/tribute, |
| resisted and retained autonomy. |
| -> State incorporation was graded: route control, tribute and alliances did not equal |
| cultural assimilation. |
| -> Wealth, office, migration, skill, patronage and renunciation enabled status claims; |
| birth, debt and stigma constrained them. |
| -> Donor records reveal claimed identity and institutional ties, not group-wide mobility; |
| many inscriptions are later. |
| -> Later Vedic -> continuity in kinship/agrarian/varna change; Buddha age -> larger states, |
| towns and organised renunciation. |
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+-----+ PANEL 14/14 - UPSC ANSWER SPINE AND MAURYAN BRIDGE +-----+	
-> Introduction: define the c. sixth-fourth centuries BCE focus, middle-Ganga weight and source problem. -> Body 1: second urbanisation and state-surplus-stratification mechanism with NBPW/coin cautions. -> Body 2: monarchy/gana, territory, officials, extraction, law and citizenship/exclusion limits. -> Body 3: varna versus jati/practice; gahapati/setthi; labour, household, women and peripheries. -> Body 4: shramana critique plus persistence; compare Later Vedic trends and regional variation. -> Conclusion: pre-Mauryan capacities formed a bridge, not a ready-made Mauryan bureaucracy or inevitable empire. +-----+	